

MATH 112B

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1 Diffusion, Wave, and Laplace

1.1 Lecture 1 - Gradient Systems

Notation: for a function with two variables

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} = \lim_{\Delta x \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(x + \Delta x, y) - f(x, y)}{\Delta x}$$
$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial y} = \lim_{\Delta y \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(x, y + \Delta y) - f(x, y)}{\Delta y}$$

Linearity.

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} cf = c \frac{\partial}{\partial x} f \quad (1)$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} (f + g) = \frac{\partial}{\partial x} f + \frac{\partial}{\partial x} g \quad (2)$$

Gradient. For $f = f(x, y)$, define the gradient as the following:

$$\vec{\nabla} f = \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}, \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \right)$$

Properties:

1. Magnitude: $|\vec{\nabla} f| = \sqrt{f_x^2 + f_y^2}$
2. Direction: $\vec{u} = \frac{\vec{\nabla} f}{|\vec{\nabla} f|} =$ unit vector in the $(\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}, \frac{\partial f}{\partial y})$ direction.
3. $\vec{\nabla} f$ at point (x_0, y_0) is $\perp$ to the level set at point (x_0, y_0) .
4. $\vec{\nabla} f$ is defined at all the points (x, y) where partials exists.
5. A collection of all $\vec{\nabla} f$ is a vector field called gradient field.
6. One could verify $F(M(x, y), N(x, y))$ is a gradient field by verifying

$$\boxed{\frac{\partial M}{\partial y} = \frac{\partial N}{\partial x}}$$

where $F = \vec{\nabla} f$

1.2 Lecture 2 - Conservation Laws

Conservation Laws

This is used to describe: bacterial movement in a petridish, nerve signal traveling through an axon, heat diffusion in a rod, cars on the highway.

We start with the following assumptions:

- Motion happens in 1D.

- Cross-sectional area is constant.

Consider a 1D tube, with particles inside. How do we describe the change of concentration of particles?

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \text{change in pop between} & & \text{rate of entry into} \quad \text{rate of exit into} \\ x \text{ and } x + \Delta x & = & (x, x + \Delta x) \quad - \quad (x, x + \Delta x) \\ & & \text{per unit time} \quad \quad \text{per unit time} \end{array}$$

Define

- $c(x, t)$ = concentration of particles at x at time t
- $J(x, t)$ = flux of particles at (x, t) = # of particles crossing a unit area at x in the positive direction, per unit time.
- A = cross-sectional area of the tube.
- ΔV = volume of our segment = $A \cdot \Delta x$

We have

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \underbrace{(c(x, t) \cdot A \cdot \Delta x)}_{\text{\# of particles}} &= J(x, t)A - J(x + \Delta x, t)A \\ \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} &= \frac{J(x, t) - J(x + \Delta x, t)}{\Delta x} \\ \lim_{\Delta x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} &= \lim_{\Delta x \rightarrow 0} \frac{J(x, t) - J(x + \Delta x, t)}{\Delta x} \\ \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} &= -\frac{\partial J}{\partial x} \leftarrow \text{Conservation of mass} \end{aligned}$$

Consider a new term,

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \Delta \text{pop between} & & \text{rate of entry into} \quad \text{rate of exit into} \quad \text{rate of local} \\ x \text{ and } x + \Delta x & = & (x, x + \Delta x) \quad - \quad (x, x + \Delta x) \quad \pm \quad \text{creation} \\ & & \text{per unit time} \quad \quad \text{per unit time} \quad \quad \text{or degradation} \end{array}$$

We now have

- $\sigma(x, t)$ = # of particles created/removed per unit volume at time t

Now our conservation laws become

$$\frac{\partial c}{\partial t} = -\frac{\partial J}{\partial x} \pm \sigma(x, t)$$

To generalize to 2D or 3D:

$$\frac{\partial c}{\partial t} = -\vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{J} \pm \sigma(\vec{x}, t)$$

Now we have $c = c(\vec{x}, t)$

$$\sigma = \sigma(\vec{x}, t)$$

$$\vec{J} = (J_x, J_y, J_z)$$

$$\vec{\nabla} = \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x}, \frac{\partial}{\partial y}, \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \right)$$

So we have

$$\frac{\partial c}{\partial t} = -\left(\frac{\partial J_x}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial J_y}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial J_z}{\partial z} \right) \pm \sigma(x, y, z, t)$$

ex Consider a moving fluid + organisms that move with the flow (not actively). Suppose that the velocity of the fluid is given by

$$\vec{v}(x, y, z, t)$$

Let $c(x, y, z, t)$ = concentration of organism.

What is the flux?

$$\begin{aligned} \vec{J} &= c \cdot \vec{V} \quad \text{Assume } \sigma = 0 \\ \Rightarrow \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} &= -\left(\frac{\partial c V_x}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial c V_y}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial c V_z}{\partial z} \right) \end{aligned}$$

In 1D:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} &= -\frac{\partial}{\partial x}(cV) \\ &= -\frac{\partial c}{\partial x}V - \frac{\partial V}{\partial x}c \end{aligned}$$

What kind of PDE is this?

- 1st order
- 2 variables: x, t
- Linear
- Transport equation

[ex] Attraction/repulsion. Suppose that ψ is a source of attraction for the bacteria. The motion is determined by the gradient of ψ .

In 1D: $\psi = \psi(x, t)$, $J = \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial x}$

$$J = c\alpha \vec{\nabla} \psi$$

We have

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} &= -\frac{\partial J}{\partial x} \\ \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} &= -\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \left(c\alpha \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial x} \right) \end{aligned}$$

ψ is given.

$$\frac{\partial c}{\partial t} = -\alpha \frac{\partial c}{\partial x} \cdot \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial x} - \alpha c \frac{\partial c}{\partial x} \cdot \frac{\partial^2 \psi}{\partial x^2}$$

This is 1st order, linear PDE in 2 variables.

[ex] Temperature of a heated rod.

Here we define $c(x, t)$ as concentration of energy/temperature. And since heat spreads from hot to cold, we get the following.

Fick's Law : $J = -D \cdot \frac{\partial c}{\partial x}$

Then we have

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} &= -\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(-D \frac{\partial c}{\partial x} \right) \\ &= D \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial x^2} \leftarrow \text{Heat equation} \end{aligned}$$

In higher dimensions:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial c}{\partial t} &= \vec{\nabla}(D\vec{\nabla}c) \\ &= D \left(\frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial z^2} \right)\end{aligned}$$

ex Random motion of particles.

Denote λ_r as the amount of particles jumping from $x \rightarrow x + \Delta x$

Denote λ_l as the amount of particles jumping from $x \rightarrow x - \Delta x$

Denote $c(x, t) = \#$ of particles within $(x, x + \Delta x)$ at time t :

$$c(x, t + \Delta t) = c(x, t) + \lambda_r \cdot c(x - \Delta x, t) + \lambda_l \cdot c(x + \Delta x, t) - \lambda_l c(x, t) - \lambda_r c(x, t)$$

Using Taylor Series:

$$\begin{aligned}c(x, t + \Delta t) &= c(x, t) + \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} \Delta t + \frac{1}{2} \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial t^2} (\Delta t)^2 + \dots \\ c(x + \Delta x, t) &= c(x, t) + \frac{\partial c}{\partial x} \Delta x + \frac{1}{2} \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial x^2} (\Delta x)^2 + \dots \\ c(x - \Delta x, t) &= c(x, t) - \frac{\partial c}{\partial x} \Delta x + \frac{1}{2} \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial x^2} (\Delta x)^2 + \dots\end{aligned}$$

We can simplify using $\lambda_r = \lambda_l = \lambda$, then we have

$$\begin{aligned}c + \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} \Delta t + \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial t^2} \frac{(\Delta t)^2}{2} + \dots &= c \\ &+ \lambda \left(c + \frac{\partial c}{\partial x} \Delta x + \frac{1}{2} \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial x^2} (\Delta x)^2 \right) \\ &+ \lambda \left(c - \frac{\partial c}{\partial x} \Delta x + \frac{1}{2} \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial x^2} (\Delta x)^2 \right) \\ &- \lambda c - \lambda c \\ \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} \Delta t + \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial t^2} \frac{(\Delta t)^2}{2} &= \lambda \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial x^2} (\Delta x)^2\end{aligned}$$

Call $\lim_{\Delta x \rightarrow 0, \Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{(\Delta x)^2}{\Delta t} \equiv K$ and ignore second order time term as we take the limit.

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial c}{\partial t} \Delta t &= \lambda (\Delta x)^2 \cdot \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial x^2} \\ \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} &= \lambda K \cdot \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial x^2} \leftarrow \text{Diffusion equation}\end{aligned}$$

1.3 Lecture 3 - Conservation Laws cont.

Recall

$$\frac{\partial c}{\partial t} = -\frac{\partial J}{\partial x} + \sigma(x, t)$$

ex Propagation of Action Potential along an axon (neural cell). Let

- x = the distance along the axon.
- $q(x, t)$ = the charge density per unit length.
- $J(x, t)$ = flux of charged particles
- $\sigma(x, t)$ = rate of charge entering/leaving

We have the following transport equation for the charge:

$$\frac{\partial q}{\partial t} = -\frac{\partial J}{\partial x} + \sigma(x, t)$$

So what is $J(x, t)$? It is the electrical current.

For $J(x, t)$, we use Ohm's Law:

$$J = -a \frac{\partial V}{\partial x}$$

where a is a constant and $\frac{\partial V}{\partial x}$ is the voltage gradient.

This relates charge to voltage:

$$q = bV$$

where q is charge, b is a constant, V is voltage.

We then have

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial}{\partial t}(bV) &= -\frac{\partial}{\partial x}\left(-a \frac{\partial V}{\partial x}\right) + \sigma(x, t) \cdot \frac{1}{b} \\ \underbrace{\frac{\partial V}{\partial t}}_{\text{diffusion eq}} &= \frac{a}{b} \frac{\partial^2 V}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\sigma(x, t)}{b} \end{aligned}$$

Generalize this to 2d or 3d

$$\frac{\partial c}{\partial t} = D \left(\frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 c}{\partial z^2} \right) \quad (\text{diffusion eq})$$

Del operator: (note that $\vec{\nabla} u = \text{grad } u$)

$$\begin{aligned} \vec{\nabla} &= \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x}, \frac{\partial}{\partial y}, \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \right) \\ u(x, y, z) &\rightarrow \vec{\nabla} \rightarrow \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial x}, \frac{\partial u}{\partial y}, \frac{\partial u}{\partial z} \right) \\ \text{scalar} &\rightarrow \vec{\nabla} \rightarrow \text{vector} \end{aligned}$$

Divergence:

Consider the dot product with $\vec{V} = (V_x, V_y, V_z)$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{V} &= \frac{\partial V_x}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial V_y}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial V_z}{\partial z} = \text{divergence of } V \\ &\text{vector} \rightarrow \text{div} \rightarrow \text{scalar} \end{aligned}$$

Laplacian:

Consider the combination of div and grad

$$\vec{\nabla}(\vec{\nabla} u)$$

where $\vec{\nabla} u = \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial x}, \frac{\partial u}{\partial y}, \frac{\partial u}{\partial z} \right)$. We have

$$\begin{aligned} \underbrace{\vec{\nabla} \cdot \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial x}, \frac{\partial u}{\partial y}, \frac{\partial u}{\partial z} \right)}_{\text{div} \cdot \text{grad } u} &= \left(\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial z^2} \right) = \underbrace{\Delta u}_{\text{Laplacian } u} \\ \Delta &= \left(\frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2}{\partial z^2} \right) \end{aligned}$$

Back to the diffusion equation

$$\frac{\partial c}{\partial t} = D \Delta c \quad (\text{diffusion eq})$$

$$\frac{\partial c}{\partial t} = D \Delta c + \sigma \quad (\text{reaction-diffusion eq})$$

where D is the diffusion coefficient.

This begs the question, what are the units of D ?

$$\frac{c}{\text{time}} = D \cdot \frac{c}{\text{space}^2}$$

$$D = \frac{\text{space}^2}{\text{time}}$$

ex How quickly can a cell get oxygen from blood? (for O_2 , $D \approx 0.2 \text{cm}^2/\text{sec}$)

1. The approximate distance through which diffusion works in a given time is $\propto \sqrt{Dt}$
2. The approximate time it takes to diffuse a distance d is $\propto \frac{d^2}{D}$

Time it takes O_2 to diffuse	
Distance	Diffusion time
1 μm	10^{-3} sec
10 μm	0.1 sec
1 mm	10^3 sec $\approx$ 15 mins
1 cm	10^5 sec $\approx$ 25 hr
1 m	10^8 sec $\approx$ 27 yrs

Role of diffusion in cancer:

Cells in the core of the tumor die due to lack of oxygen, forming a necrotic core. There was a paper by Judah Folkman in 1971, that a tumor can only grow up to 2mm in diameter (physics). This leads to tumors developing methods to deliver oxygen to its core like angiogenesis.

Consider the diffusion equation in 1d:

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = D \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2}, \quad 0 < x < l, \quad t > 0$$

We wish to find $u(x, t)$. Set the initial condition to $u(x, 0) = f(x)$. Set the boundary condition to $u(0, t) = u(l, t) = 0$, $t > 0$, this is also known as Dirichlet boundary condition.

Alternatively, we could have the Neumann boundary condition, which states

that $\frac{\partial}{\partial x}u(0, t) = \frac{\partial}{\partial x}u(l, t) = 0$. This means no flux boundary (insulating).

[ex] Consider $\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = D \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2}$, $0 < x < 1$, $t > 0$. With initial condition $u(x, 0) = f(x) = 2x^2$. With boundary condition $\begin{cases} u(0, t) = 0 \\ u(1, t) = 2 \end{cases}$. Find the long term behavior $\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} u(x, t)$.

Assume that as $t \rightarrow \infty$, the solution comes to a fixed profile.

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = D \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} = 0$$

$$\text{As } t \rightarrow \infty, \frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = 0$$

We have a boundary value problem: $\begin{cases} D \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} = 0 \Rightarrow u(x) = cx + b \\ u(0) = 0 \\ u(1) = 2 \end{cases}$

$$\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} = 0 \Rightarrow \frac{dV}{dx} = 0 \Rightarrow V(x) = c$$

Use boundary condition:

$$u(0) = c \cdot 0 + b = 0 \Rightarrow b = 0$$

$$u(1) = c \cdot 1 + 0 = 2 \Rightarrow c = 2$$

$$\Rightarrow u(x) = 2x$$

To solve PDEs, we need additional techniques.

Suppose $f(x)$ defined on $[0, \pi]$. This function can be represented as a sum of sines and cosines.

$$f(x) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} b_n \sin nx$$

where $b_n = \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi} f(x) \sin nx dx$ and

$$f(x) = \frac{a_0}{2} + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_n \cos nx$$

where $a_n = \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi} f(x) \cos nx dx$.

This is known as sine and cosine series representation.

1.4 Lecture 4 - Solving The Diffusion Equation

Given

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} &= D \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} \\ 0 &< x < \pi \\ t &> 0\end{aligned}\tag{1}$$

and the following IC and BCs (Dirichlet)

$$u(x, 0) = f(x) = x(\pi - x)\tag{2}$$

$$u(0, t) = 0\tag{3}$$

$$u(\pi, t) = 0\tag{4}$$

Use the Method of Separation of variables.

Goal: find $u(x, t)$

Assumption: $u(x, t) = X(x) \cdot T(t)$

Substitute into (1)

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial}{\partial t}(XT) &= D \frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2}(XT) \\ XT' &= DTX'' \\ \frac{T'}{DT} &= \frac{X''}{X} = -\lambda \text{ const}\end{aligned}$$

Using (3), (4):

$$\begin{aligned}u(0, t) &= X(0) \cdot T(t) = 0 \\ &\Rightarrow X(0) = 0\end{aligned}$$

From (4):

$$\begin{aligned}u(\pi, t) &= X(\pi)T(t) = 0 \\ &\Rightarrow X(\pi) = 0\end{aligned}$$

So we have the following

$$\begin{aligned}X'' + \lambda X &= 0 \\ \begin{cases} X(0) = 0 \\ X(\pi) = 0 \end{cases}\end{aligned}\tag{*}$$

For time, let us use (2):

$$u(x, 0) = X(x)T(0) = f(x)$$

$$\text{But } T(0) \neq \frac{f(x)}{X(x)}$$

So we have the following

$$T' = -\lambda DT \quad \text{with no init cond} \quad (**)$$

Now consider the case where $\lambda < 0$

$$X'' - |\lambda|X = 0$$

Take $X(x) = e^{px}$

$$p^2 - |\lambda| = 0$$

$$p = \pm \sqrt{|\lambda|}$$

We have the following general solution to $X(x)$

$$X(x) = Ae^{\sqrt{|\lambda|x}} + Be^{-\sqrt{|\lambda|x}}$$

using BC

$$X(0) = Ae^0 + Be^0 = 0$$

$$B = -A$$

$$X(\pi) = Ae^{\sqrt{|\lambda|\pi}} - Ae^{-\sqrt{|\lambda|\pi}} = 0$$

$$A \left(e^{\sqrt{|\lambda|\pi}} - e^{-\sqrt{|\lambda|\pi}} \right) = 0$$

$$e^{\sqrt{|\lambda|\pi}} = e^{-\sqrt{|\lambda|\pi}}$$

$$e^{2\sqrt{|\lambda|\pi}} = 1$$

This is only possible if $\lambda = 0$, but $\lambda < 0$.

$$\Rightarrow A = B = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow X(x) = 0$$

No nontrivial solution.

Now consider the case where $\lambda = 0$

$$\begin{aligned} X'' &= 0 \\ X(x) &= Ax + B \\ X(0) &= B = 0 \\ X(\pi) &= A\pi = 0 \Rightarrow A = 0 \\ &\text{No nontrivial solution.} \end{aligned}$$

Now consider the case where $\lambda > 0$

$$X'' + |\lambda|X = 0$$

We have the following general solution

$$\begin{aligned} X(x) &= A \cos(\sqrt{\lambda}x) + B \sin(\sqrt{\lambda}x) \\ X(0) &= A = 0 \\ X(\pi) &= B \sin(\sqrt{\lambda}\pi) = 0 \end{aligned}$$

Can we have $\sin(\sqrt{\lambda}\pi) = 0$?

If $\sqrt{\lambda}\pi = k\pi \Rightarrow \sin(\sqrt{\lambda}\pi) = 0$!

$$\begin{aligned} \sqrt{\lambda} &= k, \quad k = 1, 2, 3, \dots \\ \lambda_k &= k^2 \end{aligned}$$

Realize that nontrivial solution are possible if $\lambda_k = k^2$, $k = 1, 2, 3, \dots$, where λ_k are eigenvalues.

$$\begin{aligned} X(x) &= B \sin(\sqrt{\lambda}\pi) \\ X_k(x) &= \underbrace{B \sin(k\pi)}_{\text{eigenfunction}} \end{aligned}$$

Recall (**)

$$\begin{aligned} T' &= -\lambda DT \\ &= -\lambda_k DT \\ &= -k^2 DT \\ T_k(t) &= T_0 e^{-k^2 DT} \end{aligned}$$

These satisfy (1), (3), (4) but not (2), therefore these are partial solutions.

$$U_k(x, t) = X(x) \cdot T(t) = \text{const} \cdot \sin(kx) \cdot e^{-Dk^2T}$$

Look for the full solution as

$$\begin{aligned} u(x, t) &= \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} C_k \cdot u_k(x, t) \\ &= \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} C_k \cdot \sin(kx) \cdot e^{-k^2DT} \end{aligned}$$

where C_k is unknown.

We need to find C_k such that $u(x, 0) = f(x) = x(\pi - x)$

$$u(x, 0) = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} C_k \sin(kx) \cdot 1 = f(x)$$

Find C_k

$$\begin{aligned} C_k &= \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi} f(x) \sin(kx) dx \\ &= \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi} x(\pi - x) \sin(kx) dx \\ &= \frac{4(1 - \cos(k\pi))}{k^3\pi} \\ &= \begin{cases} 0 & k \text{ even} \\ \frac{8}{k^3\pi} & k \text{ odd} \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned} u(x, t) &= \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} C_k \sin(kx) e^{-k^2DT} \\ \Rightarrow \lim_{T \rightarrow \infty} u(x, t) &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

Try solving the diffusion equation using Neumann BC.

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial x}(0, t) = \frac{\partial u}{\partial x}(\pi, t) = 0$$

We have

$$\begin{cases} X'' + \lambda X = 0 \\ X'(0) = 0 \\ X'(\pi) = 0 \end{cases} \quad (*)$$

This gives an eigenvalue problem:

1. $\lambda < 0 \Rightarrow$ no nontrivial solution.
2. $\lambda = 0, X'' = 0$

$$\begin{aligned} X(x) &= Ax + B \\ X'(x) &= A \\ X'(0) &= A = 0 \\ X'(\pi) &= A = 0 \end{aligned}$$

Here we do have a nontrivial solution: $X(x) = B = \text{const}$

3. $\lambda > 0, X(x) = A \cos \sqrt{\lambda}x + B \sin \sqrt{\lambda}x$

$$\begin{aligned} X'(x) &= -\sqrt{\lambda}A \sin \sqrt{\lambda}x + \sqrt{\lambda}B \cos \sqrt{\lambda}x \\ X'(0) &= -\sqrt{\lambda}A \cdot 0 + \sqrt{\lambda}B \cdot 1 = 0 \\ &\Rightarrow B = 0 \\ X'(\pi) &= -\sqrt{\lambda}A \sin \sqrt{\lambda}\pi = 0 \\ \sin \sqrt{\lambda}\pi &= 0 \text{ if } \sqrt{\lambda}\pi = k\pi \\ &\Rightarrow \lambda = k^2 \text{ works !} \end{aligned}$$

We have the following eigenfunction:

$$\begin{aligned} X_k(x) &= A \cos \sqrt{\lambda}x = A \cos kx \\ k &= 0, 1, 2, \dots \end{aligned}$$

and the following partial solution:

$$u_k(x, t) = \cos kx \cdot e^{-k^2 Dt}$$

Again this satisfies (1), (3), (4). Construct

$$\begin{aligned} u(x, t) &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} C_k u_k(x, t) \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} C_k \cos(kx) e^{-k^2 Dt} \end{aligned}$$

We need to have $u(x, 0) = f(x)$, so we want

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} C_k \cos kx = f(x)$$

Find C_k

$$\begin{aligned} C_k &= \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi} f(x) \cos kx dx \\ &= \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi} x(\pi - x) \cos kx dx \\ &= -\frac{2}{k^2} (\cos k\pi + 1) = \begin{cases} -\frac{4}{k^2} & k \text{ even} \\ 0 & k \text{ odd} \end{cases} \\ C_0 &= \frac{1}{2} \cdot \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi} \pi(x - \pi) dx = \frac{\pi^2}{3} \end{aligned}$$

So we have

$$\begin{aligned} u(x, t) &= C_0 + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} C_k \cos kx \cdot e^{-k^2 Dt} \\ \lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} u(x, t) &= C_0 \\ &= \frac{1}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi} \pi(x - \pi) \\ &= \frac{1}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi} f(x) dx = f_{\text{avg}} \end{aligned}$$

1.5 Lecture 6 - Chemotaxis

Comparing solutions to diffusion and reaction-diffusion equations.

$$u_t = Du_{xx}$$

$$u(x, t) \propto \frac{1}{2(\pi Dt)^{\frac{1}{2}}} \exp\left(-\frac{x^2}{4Dt}\right)$$

$$\text{Spread: } x \propto \sqrt{t}$$

For the reaction-diffusion equation

$$u_t = Du_{xx} + ru$$

$$u(x, t) \propto \frac{1}{2(\pi Dt)^{\frac{1}{2}}} \exp\left(rt - \frac{x^2}{4Dt}\right)$$

$$\text{Spread: } x \propto t$$

Spread of muskrats. This phenomenon is in 2d. Calculate the area $A(t)$, then take $\sqrt{A(t)}$ to get a linear size. We can then plot this as a function of t , and get a positive linear relationship.

Without space, we have the following equations for growth:

$$u_t = ru \quad (\text{exponential})$$

$$u_t = ru\left(1 - \frac{u}{K}\right) \quad (\text{logistic})$$

$$u_t = ru\left(1 - \frac{u}{K}\right) - p\frac{u^2}{1+u^2} \quad (\text{predation})$$

We also apply this to reaction-diffusion equation (growth with space)

$$u_t = D\Delta u + ru\left(1 - \frac{u}{K}\right)$$

$$u_t = D\Delta u + ru\left(1 - \frac{u}{K}\right) - p\frac{u^2}{1+u^2}$$

Chemotaxis: A system of 2 reaction-diffusion equations.

- $b(x, t)$ = concentration of bacteria
- $s(x, t)$ = concentration of substrate

- $f(s)$ = growth of bacteria
- Y = yield
- k_c = bacterial death rate

We have the following system

$$\begin{aligned} b_t &= \mu b_{xx} + f(s)b - k_c b \\ s_t &= D s_{xx} - \frac{1}{Y} f(s)b \end{aligned}$$

To solve this system analytically, we have to simplify. Consider a similar system

$$B_t = -\frac{\partial}{\partial x}(\chi B c_x) + \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(\mu B_x)$$

- $B(x, t)$ = concentration of bacteria
- $c(x, t)$ = concentration of substrate
- χ = chemotactic constant
- $J_{\text{chemo}} = \chi B c_x$ = chemotactic flux
- $J_{\text{diffusion}} = -\mu B_x$ = diffusion flux

So we have

$$B_t = -\chi(B_x c_x + B c_{xx}) + \underbrace{\mu B_{xx}}_{\text{diff}}$$

Impose boundary conditions: assume $x \in [0, L]$ and no flux at boundary ($J_{\text{chem}} + J_{\text{diff}} = 0$).

$$B_x(0, t) = B_x(L, t) = 0$$

Solve the PDE in steady state (take $B_t = 0$)

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(-\chi B c_x + \mu B_x) &= 0 && \text{(conservation law)} \\ \Rightarrow -\chi B c_x + \mu B_x &= \gamma = J_{\text{tot}} \end{aligned}$$

What is γ ?

We know that $J(0, t) = J(L, t) = 0 \Rightarrow J_{\text{tot}}(x, t) = 0$

$$\begin{aligned} J_{\text{tot}} &= -\chi B c_x + \mu B_x = 0 \\ \Rightarrow \chi c_x &= \frac{\mu}{B} B_x \\ \chi c(x) &= \mu \ln B(x) + K \\ B(x) &= K \exp\left(\frac{\chi c(x)}{\mu}\right) \end{aligned}$$

ex 2 bacterial populations, $u(x, t)$ and $v(x, t)$. They disperse in response to the total density, $u + v$.

$$\begin{aligned} u(x, t) \text{ has flux } q &= -k_1 \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) \\ v(x, t) \text{ has flux } w &= -k_2 \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) \end{aligned}$$

So we have

$$\begin{aligned} u_t &= -(qu)_x \\ v_t &= -(wv)_x \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} u_t &= k_1 \frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(u \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) \right) \\ v_t &= k_2 \frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(v \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) \right) \end{aligned}$$

Solve in steady state: $\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \rightarrow 0$

$$\begin{aligned} u_t &= v_t = 0 \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(u \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) \right) &= 0 \Rightarrow u \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) = c_1 \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(v \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) \right) &= 0 \Rightarrow v \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) = c_2 \end{aligned}$$

Case 1: $c_1 = c_2 = 0$

$$\begin{aligned} u \cdot \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) = 0 &\Rightarrow u = 0 \text{ or } \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) = 0 \\ v \cdot \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) = 0 &\Rightarrow v = 0 \text{ or } \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) = 0 \end{aligned}$$

Possible solutions:

$$1a) \quad u = 0 \text{ and } v = k_2 \text{ or } v = 0 \text{ and } u = k_1$$

$$2a) \quad u \neq 0 \text{ and } v \neq 0 \Rightarrow \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) = 0 \Rightarrow u = K - v$$

Case 2: $c_1 \neq 0, c_2 \neq 0$

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(u + v) &= \frac{c_1}{u} = \frac{c_2}{v} \\ &\Rightarrow u = \frac{c_1}{c_2}v \end{aligned}$$

We can integrate this and get

$$\begin{aligned} \left(1 + \frac{c_1}{c_2}\right) v_x &= \frac{c_2}{v} \\ \Rightarrow \int v dv &= \int \frac{c_2}{1 + \frac{c_1}{c_2}} dx \\ \frac{v^2}{2} &= \left(\frac{c_2}{1 + \frac{c_1}{c_2}}\right) x + K \\ v &= \left(2x \frac{c_2}{1 + \frac{c_1}{c_2}} + K\right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \\ \Rightarrow u &= \frac{c_1}{c_2}v \end{aligned}$$

So far we have used several ways to reduce PDEs to ODEs:

- Separation of variables / sine and cosine series (bounded domain, IVP, BVP)
- Fourier transform (infinite domain)

- Looked at steady states

$$u_t = 0 \quad (\text{convergence?})$$

- Traveling wave solution, reduces to an ODE.

ex Traveling wave

$$f(x) = 1 - x^2$$

Replace $x \rightarrow x - vt \equiv z$ where v is some constant. Now we have

$$f(z) = f(x - vt) \equiv F(x, t)$$

which is a function of 2 variables.

1.6 Lecture 7 - Traveling Waves

ex Consider $f(x) = 1 - x^2$, $z = x - vt$, where v is some constant > 0 .

$$F(x, t) = f(z) = 1 - (x - vt)^2$$

Take snapshots at certain time intervals:

t	$f(z)$
$t = 0$	$f(x)$
$t = 1$	$f(x - 1)$
$t = 2$	$f(x - 2)$
$\vdots$	$\vdots$

We get a traveling wave at rate v units per time t to the right. If v is negative, it moves to the left.

Consider the Reaction-diffusion equation that describes the spread of a gene in a population. Consider also 2 alleles, a and A . Call $p(x, t)$ the frequency of individuals with the a allele. We have

$$p_t = Dp_{xx} + \alpha p(1 - p)$$

$$0 \leq p(x, t) \leq 1$$

where D is the diffusion constant, and α is the degree of advantage presented by type a . This is derived from Hardy-Weinberg genetics. This is also a 2nd order nonlinear PDE, which means it is difficult to solve. We will look for special solutions in the form of a traveling wave.

Assume that $p(x, t) = P(z)$, where $z = x - vt$ for some constant v . This reduces the PDE to an ODE.

$$\begin{aligned} f(x - vt) &= F(z) \\ f_x &= F_z z_x \\ &= F_z \\ f_{xx} &= F_{zz} \\ f_t &= F_z z_t \\ &= -v F_z \end{aligned}$$

So we have

$$-v P_z = D P_{zz} + \alpha P(1 - P)$$

Now we have a 2nd order ODE, call $\frac{dP}{dz} = -S$

$$\begin{aligned} vS &= D S_z + \alpha P(1 - P) \\ \begin{cases} P_z = -S \\ S_z = -\frac{\alpha}{D} P(1 - P) + \frac{vS}{D} \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

Use nullclines:

$$\begin{aligned} P \text{ nullclines : } S &= 0 \\ S \text{ nullclines : } -\frac{\alpha}{D} P(1 - P) + \frac{vS}{D} &= 0 \\ s &= \frac{\alpha}{v} P(1 - P) \end{aligned}$$

If we plot these nullclines we get the intersection of these nullclines at

$$\begin{aligned} (P, S) &= (0, 0) \text{ and} \\ (P, S) &= (1, 0) \end{aligned}$$

We now perform stability analysis:

$$J = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ \frac{\alpha}{D}(1-2P) & -\frac{v}{D} \end{bmatrix}$$

For $(0,0)$, λ is real if $\frac{v^2}{D^2} - \frac{4\alpha}{D} > 0$

$$\begin{aligned} \left(\frac{v}{D}\right)^2 &> \frac{4\alpha}{D} \\ \frac{v}{D} &> 2\sqrt{\frac{\alpha}{D}} \\ v &\geq 2\sqrt{\alpha D} \end{aligned} \quad (*)$$

Recall that the equilibrium is stable if $\text{Det}J > 0$ and $\text{Tr}J < 0$.

$$\begin{aligned} J(1,0) &= \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ -\frac{\alpha}{D} & -\frac{v}{D} \end{bmatrix} \\ \text{Tr}J &= -\frac{v}{D} < 0 \\ \text{Det}J &= -\frac{\alpha}{D} < 0 \\ &\text{unstable !} \end{aligned}$$

There is a trajectory that connects $(1,0)$ which is unstable, with $(0,0)$, which is stable. It is called a heteroclinic orbit.

$$\text{Corresponds to } \begin{cases} \text{as } z \rightarrow +\infty \text{ approach } (0,0) \\ \text{as } z \rightarrow -\infty \text{ approach } (1,0) \end{cases}$$

Note here that z is NOT time.

The heteroclinic orbit is the only important orbit. If $(*)$ is violated, the eigenvalues of $(0,0)$ have an imaginary part, resulting in a stable spiral. This causes the heteroclinic orbit to cross into negative values of P , which does not make sense.

We can draw a function of $P(z)$ and z , which looks like a "negative logistic growth" function. By reintroducing $z = x - vt$, we get a moving wave, describing the spread of the advantageous allele over space and time.

With much work, one can show that the velocity of spread v , is given by

$$v = 2\sqrt{\alpha D}$$

1.6.1 Turing Instability

Consider the Belousov-Zhabotinsky reaction in 1d where there is 2 substances whose concentration is given by

$$u_1(x, t) \text{ and } u_2(x, t)$$

We have

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial u_1}{\partial t} = f_1(u_1, u_2) + D_1 \frac{\partial^2 u_1}{\partial x^2} \\ \frac{\partial u_2}{\partial t} = \underbrace{f_2(u_1, u_2)}_{\text{reaction}} + \underbrace{D_2 \frac{\partial^2 u_2}{\partial x^2}}_{\text{diffusion}} \end{cases}$$

We have a system of 2 reaction-diffusion equations. Before spatial analysis, consider the non-spatial part.

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial u_1}{\partial t} = f_1(u_1, u_2) \\ \frac{\partial u_2}{\partial t} = f_2(u_1, u_2) \end{cases}$$

ex Consider $\begin{cases} f_1 = -u_1^3 + e^{u_2} \\ f_2 = -4u_1 + e^{u_2} \end{cases}$

Find steady states of the above system:

$$\begin{aligned} e^{u_2} &= u_1^3 \\ 4u_1 - u_1^3 &= 0 \\ u_1(4 - u_1^2) &= 0 \\ u_1(2 - u_1)(2 + u_1) &= 0 \\ \Rightarrow u_1 &= 0, 2, -2 \end{aligned}$$

$u_1 = 0, -2$ does not make sense because we have $e^{u_2} = 4u_1$

1.7 Lecture 8 - Turing Instability

Recall our system of reaction-diffusion equations

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial u_1}{\partial t} = f_1(u_1, u_2) + D_1 \frac{\partial^2 u_1}{\partial x^2} \\ \frac{\partial u_2}{\partial t} = f_2(u_1, u_2) + D_2 \frac{\partial^2 u_2}{\partial x^2} \end{cases}$$

We start with a system without diffusion, find solutions, study their stability, add diffusion back, see what happens. So first we consider

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial u_1}{\partial t} = f_1(u_1, u_2) \\ \frac{\partial u_2}{\partial t} = f_2(u_1, u_2) \end{cases} \quad (*)$$

Suppose there is a solution

$$u_1(t) = u_{1b} \quad u_2(t) = u_{2b}$$

where u_{1b} and u_{2b} are constants and are the equilibrium of $(*)$. This means that they satisfy $(*)$.

To study stability of $(*)$, we need the Jacobian evaluated at (u_{1b}, u_{2b}) . Call

$$\begin{aligned} a_{11} &= \left. \frac{\partial f_1}{\partial u_1} \right|_{(u_{1b}, u_{2b})} & a_{12} &= \left. \frac{\partial f_1}{\partial u_2} \right|_{(u_{1b}, u_{2b})} \\ a_{21} &= \left. \frac{\partial f_2}{\partial u_1} \right|_{(u_{1b}, u_{2b})} & a_{22} &= \left. \frac{\partial f_2}{\partial u_2} \right|_{(u_{1b}, u_{2b})} \end{aligned}$$

Consider a perturbation of the equilibrium:

$$u_1(t) = u_{1b} + v_1(t) \quad u_2(t) = u_{2b} + v_2(t)$$

Then we have
$$\begin{cases} \dot{v}_1 = a_{11}v_1 + a_{12}v_2 \\ \dot{v}_2 = a_{21}v_1 + a_{22}v_2 \end{cases}$$

We need to calculate eigenvalues. Stability is defined by eigenvalues of matrix

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} \\ a_{21} & a_{22} \end{bmatrix}$$

It is stable if $\text{Tr}A < 0$ and $\text{Det}A > 0$. Let us assume that this equilibrium is stable, that is, $\text{Tr}A < 0$ and $\text{Det}A > 0$.

How can we study the stability of the spatial system (with diffusion)?

Again, we perturb (u_{1b}, u_{2b}) , but now

$$\begin{aligned}u_1(x, t) &= u_{1b} + v_1(x, t) \\ u_2(x, t) &= u_{2b} + v_2(x, t)\end{aligned}$$

Substitute this back into the original system.

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial u_1}{\partial t} &= \frac{\partial}{\partial t}(u_{1b} + v_1) = \frac{\partial v_1}{\partial t} \\ \frac{\partial^2 u_1}{\partial x^2} &= \frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2}(u_{1b} + v_1) = \frac{\partial^2 v_1}{\partial x^2}\end{aligned}$$

We use Taylor series

$$\begin{aligned}f_1(u_1, u_2) &= f_1(u_{1b} + v_1, u_{2b} + v_2) \\ &\approx f_1(u_{1b}, u_{2b}) + \frac{\partial f_1}{\partial u_1}v_1 + \frac{\partial f_1}{\partial u_2}v_2 + \dots\end{aligned}$$

So we have

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial v_1}{\partial t} = a_{11}v_1 + a_{12}v_2 + D_1 \frac{\partial^2 v_1}{\partial x^2} \\ \frac{\partial v_2}{\partial t} = a_{21}v_1 + a_{22}v_2 + D_2 \frac{\partial^2 v_2}{\partial x^2} \end{cases}$$

Now we use the Fourier transform, with $v_1 \mapsto \hat{v}_1$ and $v_2 \mapsto \hat{v}_2$

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{v}_1(k, t) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} v_1(x, t)e^{-ikx}dx \\ \hat{v}_2(k, t) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} v_2(x, t)e^{-ikx}dx\end{aligned}$$

The back transform here is

$$\begin{aligned}v_1(x, t) &= \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \hat{v}_1(k, t)e^{ikx}dk \\ v_2(x, t) &= \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \hat{v}_2(k, t)e^{ikx}dk\end{aligned}$$

We have

$$\begin{aligned}
 \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\partial v_1}{\partial t} e^{-ikx} dx &= \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} v_1 e^{-ikx} dx \\
 &= \frac{\partial \hat{v}}{\partial t} \\
 &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (a_{11}v_1 + a_{12}v_2) e^{-ikx} dx + D_1 \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\partial^2 v_1}{\partial x^2} e^{-ikx} dx \\
 &= a_{11} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} v_1 e^{-ikx} dx + a_{12} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} v_2 e^{-ikx} dx - D_1 k^2 \hat{v}_1 \\
 &= a_{11} \hat{v}_1 + a_{12} \hat{v}_2 - D_1 k^2 \hat{v}_1
 \end{aligned}$$

We now have a system of linear ODEs!

$$\begin{aligned}
 \frac{\partial \hat{v}_1}{\partial t} &= a_{11} \hat{v}_1 + a_{12} \hat{v}_2 - D_1 k^2 \hat{v}_1 \\
 \frac{\partial \hat{v}_2}{\partial t} &= a_{21} \hat{v}_1 + a_{22} \hat{v}_2 - D_2 k^2 \hat{v}_2
 \end{aligned}$$

Our new Jacobian is

$$A(k) = \begin{bmatrix} a_{11} - D_1 k^2 & a_{12} \\ a_{21} & a_{22} - D_2 k^2 \end{bmatrix}$$

For each k , we can determine the long-term evolution (growth vs decay) of $\hat{v}(k, t)$ using the Jacobian above.

For stability, (that is, $\hat{v}(k, t) \rightarrow 0$), we need $\text{Tr}A(k) < 0$ and $\text{Det}A(k) > 0$. For instability, one or both should be violated.

$$\text{Tr}A(k) = a_{11} - k^2 D_1 + a_{22} - k^2 D_2 < 0 \quad \text{always}$$

The only way to make this unstable is to make $\text{Det}A(k) < 0$

$$\text{Det}A(k) = (a_{11} - k^2 D_1)(a_{22} - k^2 D_2) - a_{12}a_{21} \equiv F(q)$$

Call $k^2 \equiv q$.

$$\begin{aligned}
 F(q) &= D_1 D_2 q^2 - (a_{11} D_2 + a_{22} D_1) q + a_{11} a_{22} - a_{12} a_{21} \\
 &= D_1 D_2 q^2 - (a_{11} D_2 + a_{22} D_1) q + \text{Det}A
 \end{aligned}$$

To find the minimum of $F(q)$

$$\begin{aligned} F_q &= 2qD_1D_2 - (a_{11}D_2 + a_{22}D_1) = 0 \\ \Rightarrow q_{\min} &= \frac{a_{11}D_2 + a_{22}D_1}{2D_1D_2} \end{aligned}$$

We want this quantity above to be greater than 0 AND we want $F(q_{\min}) < 0$

$$F(q_{\min}) = D_1a_{22} + D_2a_{11} > 2\sqrt{D_1D_2(a_{11}a_{22} - a_{12}a_{21})}$$

This above is the condition for instability of solution (u_{1b}, u_{2b}) in the presence of diffusion. Beautiful!

A weaker but necessary condition for Turing instability.

$$D_1a_{22} + D_2a_{11} > 0$$

Recall that $a_{11} + a_{22} < 0$. With these conditions, it must follow that they have different signs.

$$D_1a_{22} - D_2|a_{11}| > 0 \Rightarrow \frac{D_2}{D_1} < \frac{a_{22}}{|a_{11}|}$$

1.8 Lecture 9 - Method of Characteristics

Consider the following PDE

$$u_t = -J_x$$

We tried $J = -D \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} \Rightarrow \frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = D \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2}$. Which is a second order PDE.

Now consider $J = cu$ where c is a constant, we have

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + c \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} = 0$$

This is the transport equation. Consider a change of variables.

$$\begin{aligned} (x, t) &\rightarrow (\xi, \eta) \\ \xi &= x + ct \quad \eta = x - ct \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}u_x &= u_\xi \xi_x + u_\eta \eta_x = u_\xi \cdot 1 + u_\eta \cdot 1 \\u_t &= u_\xi \xi_t + u_\eta \eta_t = u_\xi \cdot c - u_\eta \cdot c\end{aligned}$$

Now plug this into the PDE

$$\begin{aligned}u_t + cu_x &= 0 \\c(u_\xi - u_\eta) + c(u_\xi + u_\eta) &= 0 \\2cu_\xi &= 0 \\\Rightarrow u &\text{ does not depend on } \xi \\\Rightarrow u &\text{ only depends on } \eta\end{aligned}$$

So our general solution is

$$u = f(\eta) = f(x - ct)$$

Note that this is the traveling wave problem. Now consider $f(x - ct)$, this is constant along the lines $x - ct = a$ where a is a constant. We have

$$t = \frac{x - a}{c}$$

Suppose that at $t = 0$ the solution is $u(x, 0) = e^{-|x|}$. The solution is $f(x - ct) = e^{-|x - ct|}$. How long does it take for the cusp to reach $x = x_1$? Notice that the cusp happens when $x - ct = 0$, plugging in $x = x_1$, we get

$$t = \frac{x_1}{c}$$

Consider a more general case of a transport equation

$$u_t + c(x, t)u_x = 0$$

Assume there are lines along which the solution remains constant. Express them in parametric form.

$$(x, t) \rightarrow (x(\eta), t(\eta))$$

Recall the chain rule

$$u_\eta = u_t t_\eta + u_x x_\eta$$

For the transport equation, if we take

$$\frac{\partial t}{\partial \eta} = 1 \quad \frac{\partial x}{\partial \eta} = c$$

Then our PDE is satisfied.

Usually these problems come with an IC

$$\begin{aligned} u_t + cu_x &= 0 \\ u(x, 0) &= \phi(x) \end{aligned}$$

ex Consider $\begin{cases} u_t + xu_x = 0 \\ u(x, 0) = e^{-|x|} \end{cases}$

We know that

$$u(x, t) = f(\ln |x| - t)$$

So we have

$$u(x, 0) = f(\ln |x| - t) = e^{-|x|}$$

Let $a = \ln |x| - t$, so

$$\begin{aligned} e^a &= |x| \\ \exp\{-e^a\} &= e^{-|x|} \\ f(a) &= \exp\{-e^a\} \end{aligned}$$

So our specific solution is

$$u(x, t) = \exp\{-e^{\ln |x| - t}\}$$

We can also formulate an initial-boundary value problem

$$\begin{aligned} u_t + c(x, t)u_x &= 0 \\ u(x, 0) &= f(x) \\ u(0, t) &= g(t) \end{aligned}$$

[ex] Consider the following IBVP

$$u_t + 5u_x = 0$$

$$u(x, 0) = \cos x, \quad x > 0$$

$$u(0, t) = e^{-at}, \quad t > 0$$

The characteristic lines are $x - 5t = a$, with $t = \frac{x-a}{5}$. Say we have to find $u(1, 4)$, what char passes through $(1, 4)$?

$$x - 5t = \xi$$

$$1 - 5 \cdot 4 = \xi$$

$$\xi = -19$$

$$x - 5t = -19$$

Does it hit the initial condition? ($t = 0$)

$$x - 5 \cdot 0 = -19$$

$$x = -19$$

No. Does it hit the boundary condition? ($x = 0$)

$$0 - 5t = -19$$

$$t = \frac{19}{5}$$

So we have

$$u(1, 4) = e^{-a \cdot \frac{19}{5}}$$